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CHRISTMAS 2026 EDITION

WILEY FOX TRAVEL
FAMILIES AND SOLO TRAVELLERS

THE WILEY FOX GUIDE TO

Strasbourg

For families & solo travellers

WILEY FOX RATING • MODERATE

3

OUT OF 5 • POLICE DATA JAN 2025 TO DEC 2025

CREATOR FEELING 4/5 • SAFE AND FRIENDLY - VERY CROWDED AT WEEKENDS

27 Nov

THE 2026 MARKET OPENS

Stalls 11:30-21:00 daily, from 14:00 on opening day and to 18:00 on 24 December (City of Strasbourg). The 2026 end date is not yet published.

3.4m

VISITORS IN 2024

A record. Mondays, Tuesdays and mornings are quietest; weekends are packed.

82

CREATORS • 100 VIDEOS

Paraphrased and credited, cross-checked with official sources.

Strasbourg sits on the French side of the Rhine, opposite Germany, and its historic centre – the Grande Île, a UNESCO site – is an island ringed by the River Ill. Everything visitors come for is on or beside it: the soaring Gothic cathedral, the half-timbered canals of Petite France, the Palais Rohan and Place Kléber. It is flat, compact and walkable, with trams for everything else; the station is 10–15 minutes' walk away. Creators suggest two or three days, plus a day trip to Colmar or a wine village.

At Christmas the city calls itself the Capital of Christmas. Its market, the Christkindelsmärik, dates back to 1570 and is one of Europe's oldest; today around 300 wooden chalets fill eight market areas across the island, with a 30-metre tree on Place Kléber that lights up to music every hour after dark. For families there is a free Advent Village with storytelling and workshops, carousels, a tourist train, bear-covered streets and a heated baby-changing area.

For solo travellers Strasbourg feels safe and friendly, and the trams are easy. Plan for heavy crowds at weekends, bag checks on the bridges, a market that closes at 9pm and restaurants that close earlier than you might expect, hotel prices that can triple in December, and cold, damp weather.

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France doesn't publish street-level crime data, so before you book, check your hotel's street on the Wiley Fox map and in community reports. Remember the Grande Île is closed to cars during market hours – check how you'll reach your hotel with luggage.

Fast facts

CURRENCY	Euro (EUR) - cards work in most places, but some stalls are cash only or have a €10 minimum; carry small notes
LANGUAGE	French (with Alsatian heritage) - English is spoken in tourist areas, less so in small restaurants
TIME ZONE	Central European Time (UTC+1) - one hour ahead of the UK
PLUG	Type C and E, 230V - UK plugs need an adaptor
EMERGENCY	112 all services · 17 police · 15 ambulance · 18 fire · 3237 duty pharmacy
ENTRY	UK passport issued less than 10 years before arrival and valid 3+ months after you leave the Schengen area; up to 90 days in any 180. EES biometric checks are running at the border (gov.uk, Oct 2026)
TIPPING	Service is included ('service compris') - leave a few coins for good service if you like
BEST TIME	The Christmas market from 27 November, on weekdays and mornings; May-June and September for the canals and storks

THE FESTIVE SEASON

Christmas in Strasbourg

Strasbourg's Christkindelsmärik dates back to 1570, which makes it one of the oldest Christmas markets in Europe, and the city now bills itself as the Capital of Christmas. Around 300 chalets fill eight market areas on the Grande Île, each with its own character, linked by streets decorated with lights, bears and stars. The 2026 market opens on Friday 27 November. It is very crowded - 3.4 million visitors in 2024 - and protected by a heavy security operation, with checkpoints on every bridge onto the island.

Christmas markets



Photo: Photo Claude TRUONG-NGOC · CC BY-SA 3.0



Christkindelsmärik (Place Broglie)

GRANDE ÎLE · FROM 27 NOV 2026 · 11:30-21:00 · 24 DEC TO 18:00 · GREAT FOR KIDS

The historic market, on Place Broglie in front of the town hall since 1871. Food-focused, with more than 100 stalls, covered tables and benches, bredele biscuits, pretzels, tarte flambée on baguette, potato pancakes with Munster and curry sausages. Good for decorations and the annual mugs; some creators found the crafts mass-produced.

Crowds: Busy, but several creators found it less crowded than Kléber and liked the covered eating area for warmth.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [FlorianOnAir](#), [DW Travel](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#)

Free entry · vin chaud about €4-5 + €1 cup (2025)

DETAILS

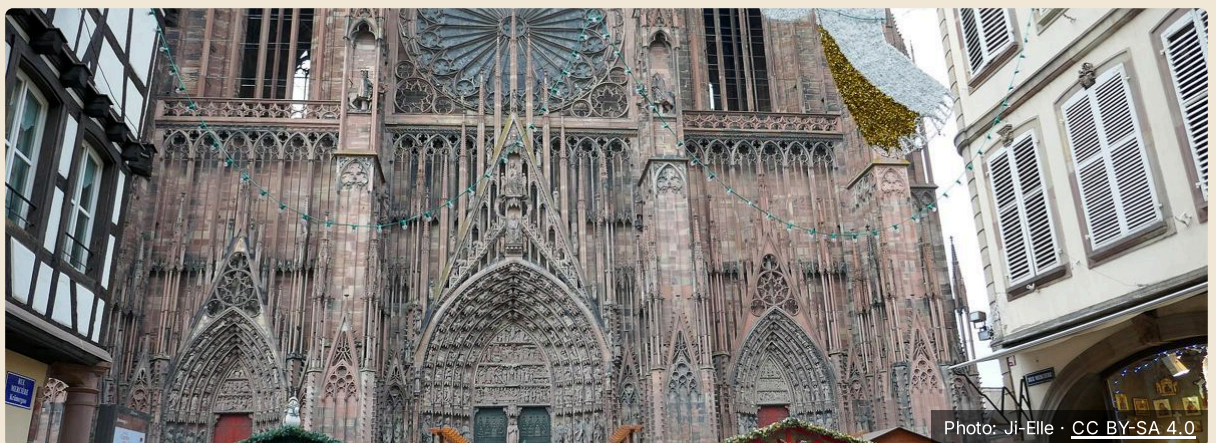


Photo: Ji-Elle · CC BY-SA 4.0



Around the Cathedral

PLACE DE LA CATHÉDRALE & PLACE DU CHÂTEAU · FROM 27 NOV 2026 · 11:30-21:00 · GREAT FOR KIDS

The prettiest and busiest market, under the floodlit cathedral: ornaments, miniature Alsatian houses, candles, crafts, a carousel and a chocolate fountain. The cathedral

glows gold at sunset.

Crowds: The most crowded market, shoulder to shoulder on evenings and weekends. Go in the morning on a weekday.

Via [Andrew & Kait](#), [Grant & Teresa](#), [Mathers On The Map](#), [Ninaderena](#), [SwissWalks4K](#), [Village City Walks](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Place Kléber & the Grand Sapin

PLACE KLÉBER • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • TREE LIT NIGHTLY • GREAT FOR KIDS

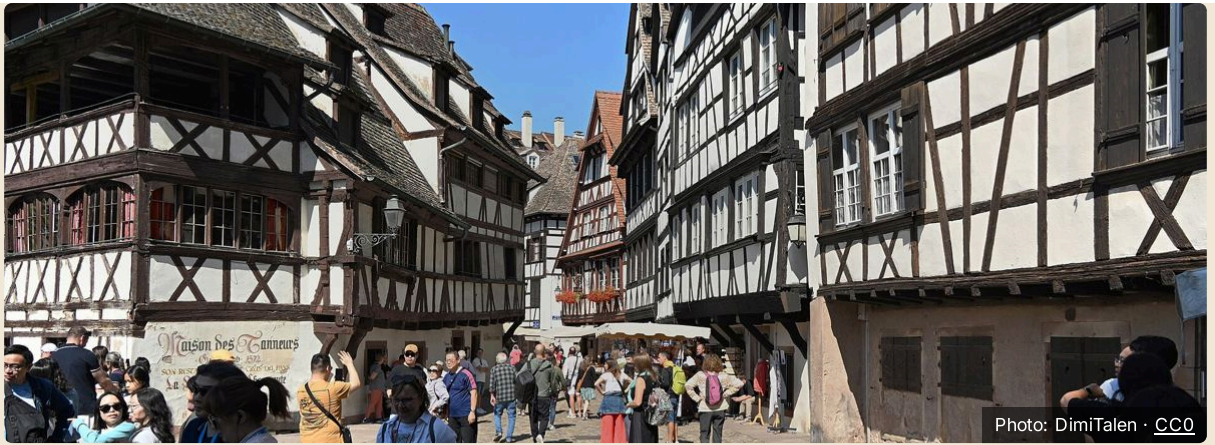
The roughly 30-metre tree, decorated to a new theme each year, lights up to music every hour after dark (creators saw shows from 4pm to 9pm). Around it, the Village du Partage gathers about 90 charities, with the star soup that raises money for good causes, and a Santa post box. Traveling Expats found the best food stalls here: spätzle €10, pork knuckle €20 (2025).

Crowds: Crowded in the evening, but space opens up about 15 metres from the tree. In 2025 the seating area here was closed at weekends to ease crowds.

Via [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [Flora and Note](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Grant & Teresa](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#)

Free

DETAILS



Petite France: Place Benjamin Zix & Place Saint-Thomas

PETITE FRANCE • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • 11:30-21:00 • GREAT FOR KIDS

Two small markets in the canal quarter. Benjamin Zix has about a dozen stalls in a very pretty corner; Saint-Thomas, beside the church, was a family favourite for Nutella-banana crêpes and big shared portions.

Crowds: Smaller and calmer, though the lanes around them are packed in the evenings.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [WonderJourneys](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Advent Village & Alsace's small producers (Square Louise Weiss)

PETITE FRANCE • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • GREAT FOR KIDS

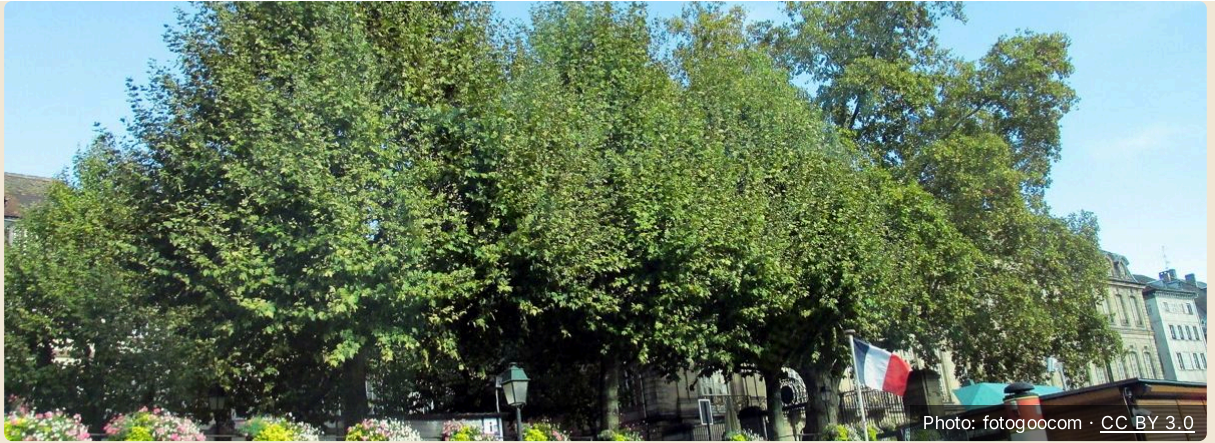
The calmest, cosiest corner: local organic wine, honey, jam, chocolate and bredele from Alsace producers, plus free daily storytelling, workshops, concerts and games for children. A heated baby-changing and feeding area is nearby.

Crowds: Quiet - lovely at night with the lights on the river.

Via [DW Travel](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#), [Prowalk Tours](#)

Free

DETAILS



The gourmet market (Terrasse Rohan & Place du Marché-aux-Poissons)

RIVERSIDE BY PALAIS ROHAN • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • GREAT FOR KIDS

A food-only market along the river under hundreds of hanging stars: biscuits, Alsace wine with tastings, local delicacies. The boat tours leave from here.

Crowds: One of the quieter markets.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Alex and Mehmet](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Carré d'Or market (Place du Temple Neuf)

GRANDE ÎLE • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • GREAT FOR KIDS

Part of the 'golden square' of streets dressed with the city's most elaborate decorations, including the teddy-bear house on Rue du Maroquin, best at dusk.

Crowds: The decorated streets are very busy in the evening; in 2025 several were made one-way at weekends.

Via [Alp Galip Travels](#), [WonderJourneys](#), [Flora and Note](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#)

Free

DETAILS



Marché OFF (Place Grimmeissen)

PETITE FRANCE • FROM 27 NOV 2026 • GREAT FOR KIDS

An alternative market in shipping containers: social and solidarity enterprises, second-hand and upcycled goods, organic food and a stage. The place for vegan hot chocolate.

Crowds: One of the quietest markets.

Via [DW Travel](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#)

Free

DETAILS

Lights, rinks and festive sights

The cathedral at Christmas

GRANDE ÎLE • MON-SAT 08:30-17:45 DURING THE MARKET • 25 DEC: CHECK (SOURCES DIFFER) • GREAT FOR KIDS



Free, with 14 tapestries shown only from Advent to Epiphany and a large nativity. Enter by the south door from Place du Château, with a bag check. The astronomical clock show does not run during the market.

Crowds: Long queues at Christmas, especially on Christmas Eve afternoon.

Via [Bucket List Urban Adventures](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Tamil Travel](#) | [Make Travel Easy](#), [Flora and Note](#)

Free

DETAILS

Christmas cruise on the Ill

FROM PALAIS ROHAN • LATEST YEAR: 28 NOV - 3 JAN, DAILY 10:00-17:45 • GREAT FOR KIDS



A heated, covered boat of about 70 minutes past Petite France and the European quarter. Book ahead - afternoons sell out.

Crowds: Book in advance at Christmas.

Via [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Les Frenchies](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#)

€16 adult • €8.90 age 4-12 (2025/26)

DETAILS



Photo: Gzen92 · CC BY-SA 4.0

Colmar Christmas markets

DAY TRIP, 30 MINUTES BY TRAIN • 23 NOV - 29 DEC 2026 • 24 DEC TO 17:00 •
GREAT FOR KIDS

Several small themed markets scattered through the old town, a Ferris wheel, a carousel and a children's market; children sail paper boats on the canals. Charming but very crowded at weekends.

Crowds: Packed on Friday evenings and weekends; the Petite Venise boat queue was about an hour.

Via [Walking & Relax](#), [Gezginbircchef](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: Gzen92 · CC BY-SA 4.0

Obernai, Riquewihr & Kayzersberg

WINE VILLAGES, DAY TRIP • OBERNAI 27 NOV - 31 DEC • RIQUEWIHR 27 NOV - 20 DEC
• KAYSERSBERG ADVENT WEEKENDS ONLY • GREAT FOR KIDS

Smaller, quieter village markets. Obernai is 30 minutes by train; Riquewihr is train plus bus; Kayzersberg opens Friday to Sunday only. Traffic and parking in Riquewihr were very bad on a December Saturday.

Crowds: Avoid weekends for the villages.

Via [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Gezginbircchef](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Baden-Baden & Gengenbach (Germany)

ACROSS THE RHINE • BADEN-BADEN 26 NOV 2026 - 6 JAN 2027 • GENGENBACH ADVENT CALENDAR LIKELY FROM 27 NOV (2026 NOT YET CONFIRMED) • GREAT FOR KIDS

Baden-Baden's market sparkles around the Kurhaus; in Gengenbach the town hall becomes a giant Advent calendar, with a window opened at 6pm each evening.

Crowds: Evenings are busiest.

Via [Silent City Walks](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Staying safe in the Christmas crowds

Crowds and timing

The city says Mondays, Tuesdays and mornings are quietest and that Wednesday afternoons, Friday evenings and weekends are very crowded; creators found 10am-4pm hectic and after 8-9pm calmer. The first weekend and the last two weekends before Christmas are the busiest.

Via [Sebby Fung](#), [WonderJourneys](#), [FlorianOnAir](#)

Security on the bridges

In 2025 more than 1,000 people a day worked on market security - police, gendarmes, Sentinelle soldiers, private guards and drone monitoring - with checks at every bridge onto the island, bulky bags searched, and cars banned during market hours. Creators found the armed patrols intense-looking but reassuring. The 2026 plan is usually announced in mid-November.

Via [Tourist Walk Tours](#), [Sebby Fung](#), [Grant & Teresa](#)

Remembering 2018

On 11 December 2018 a gunman killed five people at the Christmas market. A memorial stele stands at the foot of the Palais du Rhin on Place de la République. The UK Foreign Office says terrorists are very likely to try to attack in France; stay alert and follow police instructions.

Source: SSMSI / Préfecture du Bas-Rhin

Pickpockets

A tour guide warned of pickpockets in the cathedral and Petite France. The Foreign Office says gangs work by distraction. Keep valuables in separate inner pockets and bags across your body.

Via [Ivan de Guzman](#)

Cups, cash and food

Every drink comes in a cup with a €1 deposit (keep it, return it, or donate it to charity). Vin chaud was about €4-5 in 2025, most hot dishes €7-12, a pork knuckle €20. Carry small notes - some stalls are cash only or have a €10 card minimum. In 2022 the city asked stalls to sell regional food and set up standing areas behind the chalets for eating.

Via [Grant & Teresa](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Mandy Roams](#), [FlorianOnAir](#), [Poopi blh](#)

Have a lost-child plan

Before you go in, agree a meeting point everyone can find - the information booth on Place Kléber works well. A Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child means anyone who finds them can reach you straight away.

Source: SSMSI / Préfecture du Bas-Rhin

New Year's Eve

In 2025/26 fireworks were banned across Bas-Rhin, under-16s on their own had a curfew, and police cleared Place Kléber of fireworks just after midnight; cars were burnt in outer districts. With children, see the new year in at your hotel or a restaurant. 2026/27 rules are not out yet.

Source: SSMSI / Préfecture du Bas-Rhin

In 2026 the market opens on Friday 27 November (from 14:00), then runs 11:30-21:00 daily, closing at 18:00 on Christmas Eve; the 2026 end date is not yet published (2025 ended on 24 December). City museums are closed on 25 December (check the cathedral: sources differ), and 26 December is an extra public holiday in Alsace. Colmar runs to 29 December and Obernai to 31 December. Book hotels, restaurants and the boat early.

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the crowd at the cathedral or the Grand Sapin, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT THE DATA AND THE CREATORS SAY

*How it feels, and what the numbers show**The data*

Strasbourg is a compact, well-policed city where creators - solo women included - felt safe day and night. The main risk for visitors is theft in crowds. French police recorded 25.8 thefts without violence (which includes pickpocketing) per 1,000 residents in 2025, up 16% on 2024: more than twice the Bas-Rhin and French averages, but well below Paris (45.1), Lyon (39.3) and Bordeaux (39.1). Rates are per resident, and the city draws more than three million market visitors. Violent theft without a weapon and assault are rarer but also above the regional average, and street robbery rose in 2025. At Christmas, security is heavy: more than 1,000 people a day work on market security, every bridge onto the Grande Île has a checkpoint, and cars are banned from the island during market hours. The UK Foreign Office says terrorists are very likely to try to attack in France; a gunman killed five people at the market in December 2018. This rating is for the city as a whole: France does not publish street-level crime data.

The creators

Creators repeatedly call Strasbourg very safe. Several solo women walked through Petite France and around the cathedral until 11pm without worry, and older solo travellers found it friendly and easy. The visible armed patrols and bag checks at the market struck some as intense but reassuring. The complaints are crowds - the first weekend and the last two weekends before Christmas are shoulder to shoulder - pickpocket warnings from a tour guide at the cathedral and in Petite France, fast cyclists in pedestrian streets, hotel prices of €400-600 a night, and restaurants that close early.

What the official figures say

Figures are from the SSMSI, the French Interior Ministry's statistics service, for the commune of Strasbourg (about 294,000 residents), published in July 2026. Rates are offences recorded by police per 1,000 residents (burglary per 1,000 homes) and do not

count visitors. 2025 in Strasbourg: thefts without violence 25.8 (+16%), thefts from vehicles 6.9 (+32%), violent theft without a weapon 1.3 (+26%), assault outside the family 4.9 (-3%), home burglary 4.3 (-4%), sexual violence 2.2 (+20%). France publishes no street-level crime data, so this guide's map shows the markets, sights and the places named in official or press reports. On New Year's Eve 2025/26, fireworks and petards were banned across Bas-Rhin, under-16s on their own had a curfew, police cleared Place Kléber of fireworks just after midnight, and press counted 117-123 cars burnt across the wider area, mostly in outer districts.

25.8

THEFTS WITHOUT VIOLENCE PER 1,000 RESIDENTS (2025)

Includes pickpocketing. Up 16% on 2024; Paris 45.1, Lyon 39.3, Bas-Rhin 10.0 (SSMSI).

1,000+

PEOPLE ON MARKET SECURITY EVERY DAY (2025)

Police, gendarmes, Sentinelle soldiers and private security, with checks on every bridge onto the Grande Île (Préfecture, 2025).

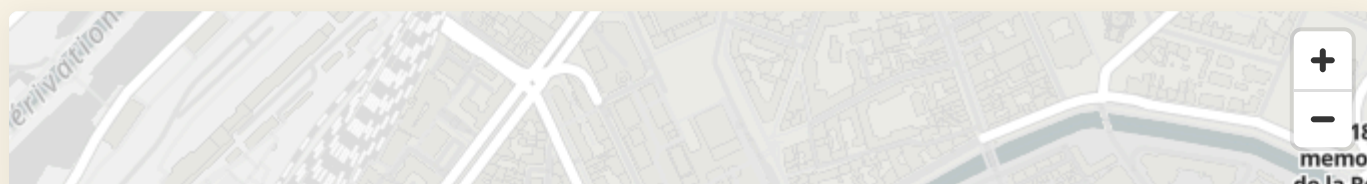
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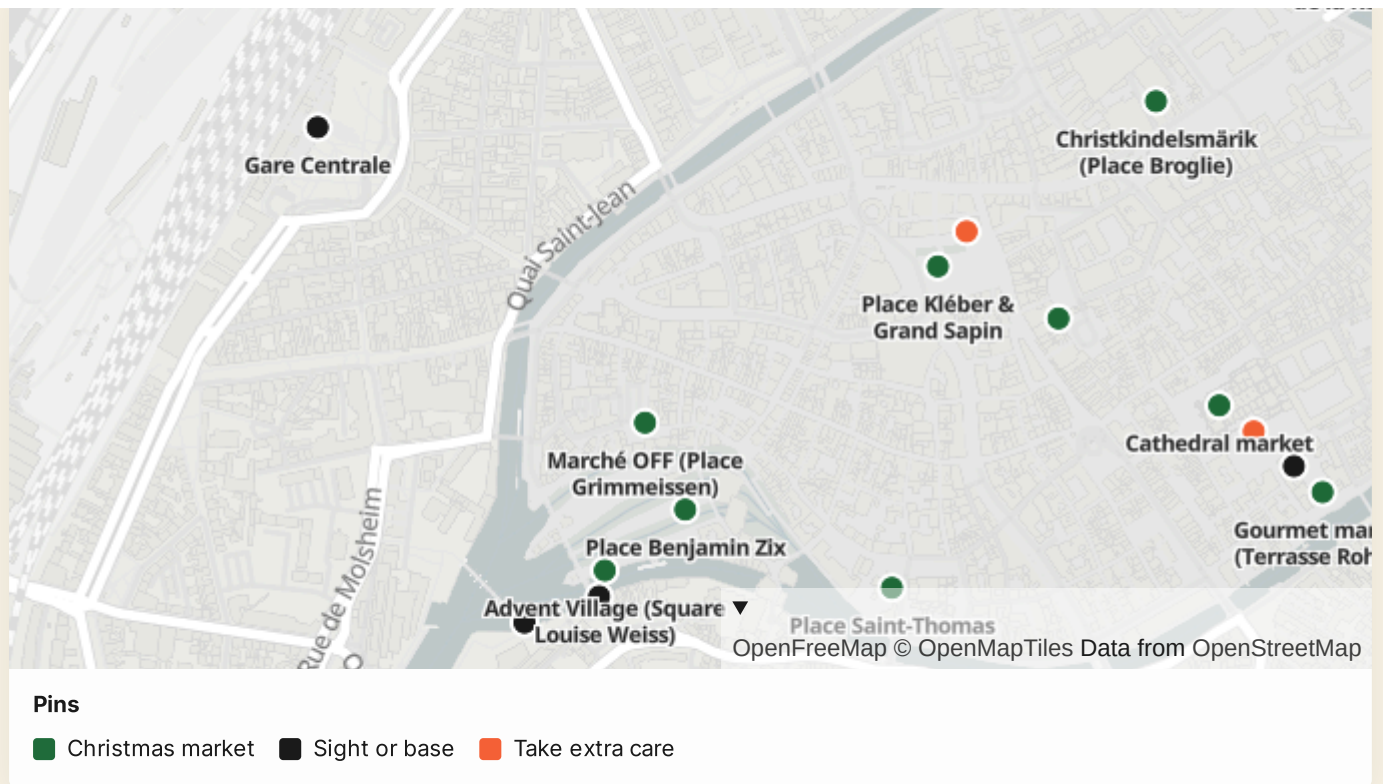
ASSAULTS OUTSIDE THE FAMILY (2025)

4.9 per 1,000 residents, against 5.3 in Paris and Lyon. Home burglary also fell 4%.

Map: markets, sights and places to take care

France doesn't publish street-level crime data, so this map shows the markets and sights in this guide, plus the busiest crowd spots and the places named in official or press reports.





Crime figures: SSMSI, Ministère de l'Intérieur - recorded crime by commune, 2025 · [Open the Wiley Fox map](#)

How Strasbourg compares with other French cities

Offences recorded by police in 2025 per 100,000 residents (burglary per 100,000 homes), from the French Interior Ministry's commune data. Strasbourg is well below Paris, Lyon and Bordeaux for theft, but above the regional and national averages - as every big tourist city is, because visitors are counted as victims but not as residents.

	THEFT WITHOUT VIOLENCE	VIOLENT THEFT	ASSAULT	HOME BURGLARY
Colmar	1,760	43	536	371
Marseille	1,932	288	503	932
Toulouse	2,050	205	496	639
Strasbourg	2,581	128	491	427
Lille	3,054	350	655	896
Bordeaux	3,906	383	509	688
Lyon	3,932	610	531	688
Paris	4,512	345	527	505

	THEFT WITHOUT VIOLENCE	VIOLENT THEFT	ASSAULT	HOME BURGLARY
France average	922	71	307	566

per 100,000 residents (burglary per 100,000 homes), 2025

France average is Wiley Fox's calculation from the department data. Violent theft means theft with force but no weapon. Compare within France only: other countries record crime differently. Lyon's violent-theft figure nearly doubled between 2024 and 2025 and may reflect a recording change. Source: [SSMSI, Ministère de l'Intérieur - bases communales de la délinquance enregistrée, 2025](#)

Areas to take extra care

None of these are no-go areas. Know the pattern, and plan your timing and your route home.

● Cathedral square and the Grand Sapin crowds

TAKE MOST CARE: AFTERNOONS, EVENINGS AND WEEKENDS

The busiest spots in the city at Christmas. A tour guide warned of pickpockets inside the cathedral and in Petite France (2025), and the UK Foreign Office says pickpockets in France work in gangs - one distracts you while another takes from your bag. Keep bags zipped and across your body, phones in front pockets, and agree a meeting point with children.

Via [Ivan de Guzman](#), [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Ece Yilmaz](#)

● Bridge checkpoints onto the Grande Île

TAKE MOST CARE: MARKET HOURS (11:30-21:00)

Every bridge onto the island has a security check during the market, run by private guards with gendarmes. Large objects and very bulky bags are searched, so leave big bags at the hotel - creators had large luggage stopped on the walk from the station. Some bridges can be closed at short notice on the Prefect's orders, and in 2025 four tram stops on the island were not served during market hours.

Via [Sebby Fung](#), [Grant & Teresa](#)

● Petite France bridges in the evening

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS AND WEEKENDS

Some of the small bridges become almost impossible to cross at peak times. The riverside paths and wider streets give the same views with more space; go early in the morning or after 8-9pm.

Via [Ece Yilmaz](#), [Travel Time - Dj0rdje1](#), [Alp Galip Travels](#)

- **Cycle lanes and pedestrian streets**

TAKE MOST CARE: ALWAYS

Strasbourg has France's biggest cycle network and bikes also use the pedestrian zones. Hold your line when you hear a bell and keep children close.

Via [Wolters World](#)

- **Place Kléber and outer districts on New Year's Eve**

TAKE MOST CARE: 31 DECEMBER NIGHT

On New Year's Eve 2025/26 police cleared Place Kléber of people firing fireworks just after midnight, and press counted more than 100 cars burnt across the wider area, mostly in outer districts. Fireworks were banned in Bas-Rhin. The 2026/27 rules are not out yet.

Source: SSMSI / Préfecture du Bas-Rhin

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The old town is quiet after the stalls close at 9pm. Save your hotel on Wiley Fox and keep SOS one tap away on the walk back.

Scams and tricks creators keep seeing

Pickpockets in the market crowds

The main risk. Keep valuables in separate pockets, bags across your body and phones in front. Colmar's crowded lanes have the same problem.

Via [Ivan de Guzman](#), [Globetrotting Graeme](#)

Cup collectors

Every drink comes in a cup with a €1 deposit. People may ask for your empty cups to cash in the deposits - you can give them away, return them, or drop them in a charity box.

Via [Traveling Expats](#), [Flora and Note](#)

Tourist-trap stalls

Some chalets sell mass-produced goods, and identical wooden items sell at different prices on different stalls. Look for named Alsatian makers - the small producers'

Card minimums and big notes

Some stalls take cash only or set a €10 card minimum, and vendors refused a €100 note. Carry small notes and coins.

Via [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [Miss Mina](#), [Traveling Expats](#)

market in Petite France is the safest bet -
and compare before you buy.

Via [FlorianOnAir](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Sebby Fung](#)

NEIGHBOURHOODS

Where to stay

Pick an area first, then a hotel. The old town is compact, so most bases are within a short walk of the markets.



Photo: Photo Claude TRUONG-NGOC · CC BY-SA 3.0

Grande Île (the old town)

FIRST-TIMERS • CHRISTMAS MARKETS • FAMILIES

Inside the island, steps from the cathedral and the markets. Creators loved waking up in the middle of it, but it is the most expensive area - €400-600 a night at Christmas, booked months ahead - and the island is closed to cars during market hours, so expect to wheel your luggage from the tram or station.

Via [Alp Galip Travels](#), [Mandy Roams](#), [alliepiki](#), [Sebby Fung](#)



Photo: Dietmar Rabich · CC BY-SA 4.0

Petite France

COUPLES • FAMILIES • SCENERY

The canal quarter at the west end of the island, with half-timbered houses, the covered bridges and the quietest markets (the Advent Village and small producers). Mid-range hotels ran about €100-200 a night outside the busiest dates (2024). Very crowded in the evenings, peaceful late at night.

Via [Tourist Walk Tours](#), [TravelSpotter](#), [Wiki Peaks](#), [Noë Rose Travels](#)

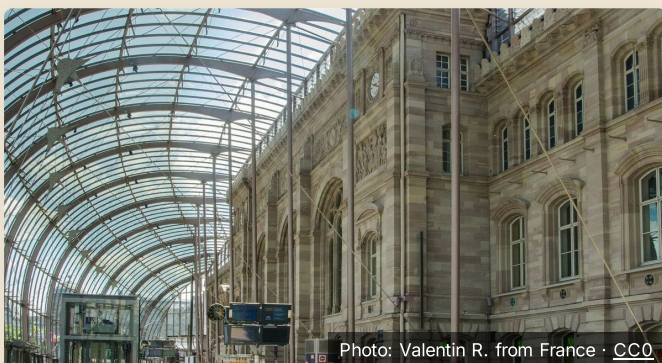


Photo: Valentin R. from France · CC0

Krutenau

SOLO TRAVELLERS • YOUNG • FOOD

The student quarter just east of the island, with cafés, bars and cheaper eats. A few minutes' walk to the cathedral.

Via [Miss Mina](#), [Le Routin](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#)

Quartier Gare (by the station)

ARRIVING BY TRAIN • BUDGET • DAY TRIPS

Modern hotels opposite the station, a flat 10-15 minute walk along pedestrian streets to the markets, and trains to Colmar every half hour. Best Western Plus Monopol Métropole was about \$200 a night for two with breakfast (2025). Large luggage is checked on the walk into the old town during the market.

Via [WithLoah - World](#), [Travel with NJ Steve & Sue!](#), [Sebby Fung](#), [where is kat](#)



Neustadt & the European quarter

QUIET NIGHTS • FAMILIES • PARKS

The grand German-era boulevards north-east of the island, near the Palais du Rhin, Parc de l'Orangerie with its storks and the European Parliament. Quieter and often cheaper, 10-20 minutes' walk or a short tram ride to the markets.

Via [Alice & Lucas Travel](#), [Nomad Flow](#), [Alp Galip Travels](#)



Further out on the tram

BUDGET • DRIVING

Alp Galip found a room for about €220 roughly ten minutes from the centre by tram when central hotels were €500-600 (2025). If you drive, the park-and-ride at Baggersee costs €4.20 a day including the tram for up to seven people.

Via [Alp Galip Travels](#), [Traveling Expats](#)

Hotels we'd start with

Wiley Fox may earn a small commission if you book through these links. Your price stays the same.

PLACE KLÉBER, GRANDE ÎLE • LUXURY

Maison Rouge Strasbourg Hotel & Spa

Historic hotel with a spa in the pedestrian zone, five minutes from the cathedral; rooms a little small. About \$370 a night for two with breakfast (2025).

€€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [WithLoah - World](#)

PETITE FRANCE • COUPLES

Hôtel & Spa Le Bouclier d'Or

A 16th-century building in Petite France with a spa, antique-furnished rooms and a tea room.

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [TravelSpotter](#)

GRANDE ÎLE • CLOSE TO THE MARKETS

Hotel Leonor

About 100 m from the markets, with a courtyard and a good breakfast buffet (December 2025).

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [alliepiki](#)

OPPOSITE THE STATION • ARRIVING BY TRAIN

Hôtel Tandem

Boutique hotel with quiet, comfortable rooms and a good breakfast, 10-15 minutes' walk to the markets (2025).

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Travel with NJ Steve & Sue!](#)

BY THE STATION • GOOD VALUE

Best Western Plus Monopol Métropole

Three minutes from the station, clean and well soundproofed; about \$200 a night for two with breakfast (2025).

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [WithLoah - World](#)

Search all Strasbourg hotels

Compare live prices, then check the street on the Wiley Fox map before you book.

SEARCH BOOKING.COM

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the crowd at the cathedral or the Grand Sapin, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT CREATORS RATE

Ten things worth your time

Ranked by how often creators recommend them. Almost everything is on the Grande Île and walkable in a day; in December do the cathedral and Petite France early, before the market opens at 11:30.



Photo: Txlxt Txlxt • CC BY-SA 4.0

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Strasbourg Cathedral

GRANDE ÎLE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The rose-pink Gothic cathedral, 142 m tall and once the tallest building in the world. Entry is free (via the south door during the market, with a bag check). At Christmas it hangs 14 tapestries of the life of the Virgin and a large nativity. Note: the famous astronomical clock show is not held during the market. Closed to visitors on Christmas Day.

Via [Culture Trekking with Janiel](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [DW Travel](#), [Growing Global Citizens](#), [Travel With Josh & Taylor](#), [SeniorSoloTravel](#), [Dramatically Expatic](#)

Free • platform climb €10, child €6

DETAILS

02



The cathedral platform

GRANDE ÎLE • GREAT FOR KIDS

330 steps (no lift) to a platform 66 m up, with views over the rooftops to the Black Forest. Queues are long around midday and at Christmas - go early or late afternoon. No big bags or luggage.

Via [Grant & Teresa](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Klara Vyletal](#), [No Space In My Passport](#)

€10 adult · €6 child (tourist office; another site says €8)

DETAILS

03



Petite France & the Ponts Couverts

PETITE FRANCE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The old tanners' and millers' quarter: half-timbered houses over the canals, a swing bridge and a lock, and the three medieval towers of the covered bridges. Best early in the morning or late in the day, when the crowds thin.

Via [Dramatically Expatic](#), [Project Gaia](#), [ViaTravelers](#), [Travel Time - Dj0rdje1](#), [Alp Galip Travels](#), [Miss Mina](#)

Free

DETAILS

04

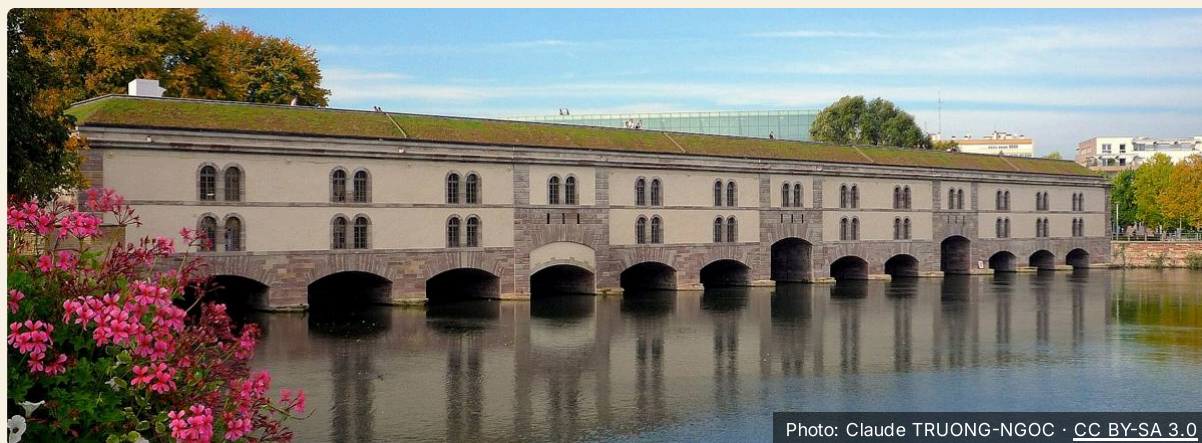


Photo: Claude TRUONG-NGOC · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

Barrage Vauban

PETITE FRANCE • GREAT FOR KIDS

A 17th-century dam with a free roof terrace looking back over the covered bridges and Petite France - the classic view, and quieter than the lanes. A small lift avoids most of the stairs. The terrace was being rebuilt in mid-2026, so check it has reopened.

Via [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Exotic Vacation](#), [Ece Yilmaz](#), [Culture Trekking with Janiel](#), [AbouTravel](#).

Free

DETAILS

05



Photo: JoachimKohler-HB · CC BY-SA 4.0

Batorama river cruise

GRANDE ÎLE · GREAT FOR KIDS

A heated, covered boat around the island, through a lock and Petite France to the European quarter - good in rain and with tired children. Creators say to book ahead at Christmas and sit on the right for Petite France.

Via [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Les Frenchies](#), [AbouTravel.](#), [Growing Global Citizens](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#)

€16 adult · €8.90 age 4-12 (2025/26)

DETAILS

06



Palais Rohan

GRANDE ÎLE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The bishops' baroque palace beside the cathedral, with three museums (fine arts, decorative arts, archaeology); the courtyard is free. At Christmas its riverside terrace hosts a gourmet market. Note: the Alsatian Museum is closed for works until 2028.

Via [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [The Travel Boss](#), [Exotic Vacation](#), [Ece Yilmaz](#)

€9 per museum · under 18 free (2026)

DETAILS

07



Parc de l'Orangerie

ORANGERIE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The city's oldest park, with a lake, a play area and a mini zoo and stork centre that young children love. Muted in winter, but a good run-around away from the crowds.

Via [Alice & Lucas Travel](#), [TravelScout](#), [ViaTravelers](#), [Growing Global Citizens](#), [Before You Go](#)

Free

DETAILS

08



Photo: jeffowenphotos · CC BY 2.0

European Parliament

EUROPEAN QUARTER · GREAT FOR KIDS

Free visits and an interactive exhibition of about an hour, with roof views; bring photo ID. Closed on Sundays and public holidays, and hours change when Parliament sits.

Via [Growing Global Citizens](#), Klara Vyletal

Free

DETAILS

09



Photo: FrDr · CC BY-SA 4.0

Historic wine cellar of the Hospices

GRANDE ÎLE · GREAT FOR KIDS

Medieval wine cellars dating to 1395 under the old hospital, with a barrel from 1472 - free to visit and a warm escape.

Via [Grant & Teresa](#)

Free

DETAILS

10



Colmar (day trip)

30 MINUTES BY TRAIN • GREAT FOR KIDS

A storybook Alsatian town with canals (Petite Venise), the Unterlinden Museum and its own Christmas markets, a Ferris wheel and a children's market. Very crowded at weekends – go on a weekday and book the boat. Creators found it easier and cheaper to stay in Strasbourg and visit.

Via [Globetrotting Graeme](#), [Walking & Relax](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [Julia Ng](#), [Nomad Flow](#)

Train about €8-12 each way · boat €9 (2025)

DETAILS

If you only have one day

ONE

1

The classic loop

- 08:30 **Petite France before the crowds.** The canals, the covered bridges and the Barrage Vauban terrace.
- 10:00 **Cathedral and platform.** Inside for the tapestries and nativity, then the 330 steps (no big bags).
- 11:30 **Markets open.** Christkindelsmärik on Place Broglie and the cathedral market while it is calmer.
- 13:00 **Lunch.** Tarte flambée in a winstub – book, as kitchens close around 2pm.
- 14:30 **Boat or museum.** Batorama cruise round the island, or Palais Rohan.

- 16:30 **Lights and the Grand Sapin.** The tree lights up to music each hour after dark; walk Rue du Maroquin and Rue Mercière.
- 18:30 **Dinner.** Choucroute at Maison Kammerzell or in Petite France.
-

Three days, grouped by area

DAY

1

The island

- AM Cathedral and platform early.
- PM Christkindelsmärik, cathedral and Kléber markets.
- EVE Grand Sapin light show and dinner in a winstub.
-

DAY

2

Petite France & family

- AM Petite France, Barrage Vauban and the boat.
- PM Advent Village and the small producers' market at Square Louise Weiss.
- EVE Place Benjamin Zix and Saint-Thomas markets; Marché OFF.
-

DAY

3

Day trip

- AM Train to Colmar (30 min) on a weekday.
- PM Petite Venise, the Unterlinden Museum and the markets.
- EVE Back for a last vin chaud - or Obernai, or Baden-Baden in Germany instead.
-

TARTE FLAMBÉE, CHOUCRUTE AND A BREDELE

Where to eat

Alsatian food is hearty and half German: tarte flambée (flammekueche, a thin crust with cream, onion and bacon), choucroute with several meats, spätzle, baeckeffe, pretzels and kougelhopf. Eat in a winstub, and book: restaurants fill at Christmas and many kitchens close around 2pm and stop early in the evening. Prices carry the year.

Maison Kammerzell

CATHEDRAL SQUARE • ALSATIAN

€€€

The 15th-century carved house beside the cathedral. Touristy, but the choucroute with three fish is worth trying and portions are huge; book at Christmas.

Family friendly

Via [Exotic Vacation](#), [Mandy Roams](#), [Miss Mina](#), [Yassoldat](#)

VISIT

Maison des Tanneurs

PETITE FRANCE • ALSATIAN

€€€

A famous riverside timbered house known for its choucroute.

Family friendly

Via [Wolters World Eats](#), [Wiki Peaks](#)

VISIT

La Corde à Linge

PETITE FRANCE • ALSATIAN

€€

Traditional choucroute with five meats and spätzle in mushroom sauce, on a pretty square.

Family friendly

Via [STUFR - Travel & Food](#)

VISIT

Le Chauvin Père et Fils

PETITE FRANCE • ALSATIAN TAPAS

€€

Small plates of local specialities for lunch or dinner - a way to try several dishes.

Family friendly

Via [STUFR - Travel & Food](#)

VISIT

Le Petit Mélie

NORTH OF THE CATHEDRAL • TARTE FLAMBÉE

€

A small family-run restaurant with house-made tarte flambée, an affordable dinner (2026).

Family friendly

Via [Exotic Vacation](#)

VISIT

Au Crocodile

RUE DE L'OUTRE • FINE DINING

€€€
€

The Michelin-starred restaurant locals most often name as Strasbourg's best - expensive but excellent.

Grown-ups

Via [Yassoldat](#)

VISIT

La Hache

STRASBOURG • BISTRO

€€

A local's pick for meat and beef tartare, with an affordable lunch menu that changes daily.

Family friendly

Via [Yassoldat](#)

VISIT

Café Potager

STRASBOURG • CAFÉ

€

Known for its carrot cake - a good warm-up stop.

Family friendly

Via [STUFR - Travel & Food](#)

VISIT

Tonton Café Gâteau

PETITE FRANCE • CAFÉ



Coffee and pastries in the canal quarter.

Family friendly

Via [STUFR - Travel & Food](#)

VISIT

Au Coin du Grill

STRASBOURG • KEBAB



A well-known local kebab shop with house-made bread: veal €9, chicken €8 (2026).
Strasbourg's kebab shops are a local institution.

Family friendly

Via [Le Routin, Isma](#)

VISIT

For a grown-ups' evening: a vin chaud blanc (Alsace makes its mulled wine with white wine and honey) or a Christmas beer at the market, then a winstub for choucroute with a glass of Riesling or crémant, or a beer with a shot of Picon like the locals. The market closes at 9pm and the old town goes quiet soon after; Krutenau has the student bars. The drinking age is 18. Opening times and menus change, so check before you travel. Wiley Fox is not paid for restaurant listings.

BEFORE YOU GO

Getting around Strasbourg

Getting there

From London, Eurostar to Paris then the TGV from Gare de l'Est: about 6 hours in all, and the TGV leg takes about 1h45-2h - book early, as December trains fill up. From Strasbourg-Entzheim airport a train runs to the station in 8 minutes (€3.20, 2026). From Basel-Mulhouse airport take the shuttle bus to Saint-Louis station, then the train.

Via [Ninaderena](#), [Mandy Roams](#), [Our Bucketlist Journal](#), [Les Frenchies](#)

Trams and tickets

A single is €1.90 on the CTS app or a CTS contactless ticket card (€2.50 bought on the bus; tapping a bank card is not confirmed), and the 24h Trio pass covers 1-3 people for €10.20 (2026), including the tram to Kehl in Germany. Under-4s ride free. Validate before you ride. During the market some island stops are skipped - use Gallia, Gare Centrale or République.

Via [Seeking Paradise Bugs](#), [Pauli](#) | [De viajes y otros demonios](#), [Tourist Walk Tours](#)

Walking the markets

The station is a flat 10-15 minutes' walk from the first chalets, and the eight market areas on the island are all within 10 minutes of each other. Cobbles are uneven - creators walked 20,000 steps a day. A little tourist train runs for tired legs.

Via [Sebby Fung](#), [Grant & Teresa](#), [Relax&Walk the World](#), [Mandy Roams](#)

Driving

Cars are banned from the Grande Île during market hours. Use a park-and-ride: €4.20 a day including the tram for up to seven people; Baggersee to Place Kléber is about 15 minutes.

Via [Traveling Expats](#)

Day trips by train

Colmar is about 30 minutes by TER, with up to three trains an hour; a return for two cost about €64 in 2025. Obernai and Sélestat are 20-30 minutes, and Riquewihr is reached by train and bus. Bus 21 or tram D crosses into Kehl, Germany.

Via [Globetrotting Graeme](#), [Marcus and Chelsey](#), [Travel with NJ Steve & Sue!](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [WithLoah](#) - [World](#)

What it costs

CTS single tram/bus ticket (app, Badgéo or reloaded card)	EUR 1.90 2026 tariff as read; verify before print
CTS single ticket bought on board	EUR 2.50 2026 tariff as read
CTS 24h Solo pass	from EUR 4.60 2026 tariff as read
CTS 24h Trio pass (up to 3 people)	EUR 10.20 2026 tariff as read
CTS 72h Solo pass	from EUR 10.20 2026 tariff as read
Park and ride (P+R) day ticket incl. tram	EUR 4.20 2025 (latest year only)
Airport to station by TER (rail only)	EUR 3.20 2026 as read; verify
TGV Paris to Strasbourg	from about EUR 25 (indicative, not a fixed fare) Indicative, checked 2026-10-06
Basel to Strasbourg train	from about EUR 11 (indicative) Indicative, not yet confirmed for Dec 2026
Cathedral platform climb (330 steps)	Adult EUR 10, child EUR 6 (another site says EUR 8; conflict) 2026 per Strasbourg Tourisme
Astronomical clock	EUR 4; EUR 3 groups/students; EUR 2 ages 6-17; free under 6 (a city page shows an older EUR 2) 2026 per cathedral site; show not held during the market
Batorama river cruise (1h10)	Adult EUR 16; 13-17 EUR 14.70; 4-12 EUR 8.90; under 4 free 2025/26 season only; 2026 not yet confirmed
City museums	EUR 9 full, EUR 5 reduced, free under 18 2026 as read
Velhop bike hire	EUR 1.20/hour; EUR 7/24h; EUR 14/48h 2026 as read
Christmas market cup deposit	EUR 1 2025 (latest year only)
Vin chaud (mulled wine)	about EUR 5 plus EUR 1 deposit (unofficial 2025 blog; BFM 2023 said EUR 5 incl. deposit)

Tourist tax (taxe de
sejour)

**5% of pre-tax room price plus 10% departmental, capped EUR 5.06 per
person per night; under 18 exempt**

2026 as read; hotel star rates from a secondary source

Creator prices carry the video date. Anything older than 18 months is marked to check.

Quick tips

Book early

Central hotels reach €400-600 a night at Christmas and sell out months ahead. Staying by the station or along the tram line is cheaper.

Go on weekdays, mornings or late

The city says Mondays, Tuesdays and mornings are quietest; Wednesday afternoons, Friday evenings and weekends are packed. Stalls open at 11:30 - see the sights first.

Small notes and the cup deposit

Some stalls are cash only or have a €10 card minimum. Every drink comes in a cup with a €1 deposit - keep it, return it to any stall, or donate it to charity.

Book dinner, eat earlier

Many kitchens stop at about 2pm and again early in the evening, and restaurants fill at Christmas. Reserve, or eat at the market.

Leave big bags at the hotel

Every bridge onto the island has a bag check during the market, and the cathedral platform has no left luggage.

Christmas Eve to 26 December

Stalls close at 18:00 on 24 December. City museums are closed on Christmas Day. The City lists the cathedral as closed on 25 December, but the cathedral's own feast-day hours are 14:00-17:15, so check before you go. 26 December is an extra public holiday in Alsace, so most shops are shut.

WF

Found a cash-only stall, a closed bridge or a street that felt wrong? Drop a community report on the map - it helps the next family.

THE SMALL THINGS VISITORS WORRY ABOUT

Local tips for Strasbourg

Every tip here was checked against an official or trusted source (the City of Strasbourg, CTS, the Préfecture, SNCF, gov.uk and others) on the date shown. Rules and prices change, so tap the link to double-check before you travel.

Paying for transport

What does a tram or bus ticket cost?

A single (1 hour) is EUR 1.90 on the CTS app, on a Badgeo card or when topping up a paper-style contactless card (BSC). Buying on board a bus costs EUR 2.50. Pairs: EUR 3.60. Ten trips: EUR 17.10 (EUR 15.20 for children 4 to 11). [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Is a day ticket worth it for a family?

24h Solo is from EUR 4.60 for one person. 24h Trio is EUR 10.20 for 1 to 3 people, valid 24 hours from first use on buses and trams, including the line D tram to Kehl in Germany. First purchase on a contactless card adds EUR 0.20. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Do small children need a ticket?

Children under 4 travel free without a ticket. From age 4 a ticket is required. Validate it even if it is free. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Can I tap my bank card on the tram?

We could not confirm on CTS pages that a bank card can be tapped on the validator. Buy a ticket on the CTS app or a contactless ticket before boarding, and validate it. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Driving in: where do I park?*

Park-and-ride (P+R) is EUR 4.20 and includes unlimited bus and tram for 1 to 7 people (parking valid 4:30 to 02:00 next day). The city centre inside the Grande Ile is closed to cars during market hours. In 2025 the P+R car parks ran 24 hours with an extra car park at the Zenith and a weekend

CHRISTMAS *Trams skip the market stops*

In 2025 the tram stops Broglie, Alt Winmaerik and Langstross Grand'Rue were not served during market hours (11:30 to 21:00), and Homme de Fer could be shut when crowded. Use Gallia, Gare Centrale or République and walk, or the line A, C, D and F stops near the venues. 2026 changes not yet confirmed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

shuttle. 2026 arrangements not yet confirmed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *How do I get from Strasbourg station to the market?*

The first chalets are about a 10 minute walk from Strasbourg Central Station. There are official information booths at Place de la Gare and Place Kleber. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

How do I get from Strasbourg-Entzheim airport?

Train shuttle to Strasbourg station takes 8 minutes, up to 5 trains an hour. A rail-only ticket is EUR 3.20 one way. With the CTS app a combined train plus tram plus bus ticket starts at EUR 1.90. An Alsa+ 24h EMS ticket (train, tram, bus, valid 24h in the metropolitan area) is EUR 4.60.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Flying into Basel-Mulhouse instead

A direct shuttle bus runs between the airport and Saint-Louis (France) station every 15 to 30 minutes from 05:00 to midnight, about 10 to 15 minutes.

EuroAirport says direct trains to Strasbourg leave Saint-Louis every 30 minutes. Price and total time to Strasbourg are not yet confirmed on an official page (SNCF Connect lists Basel to Strasbourg from EUR 11, about 1h27, indicative only).

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

London to Strasbourg by train

Eurostar to Paris Gare du Nord, then a TGV from Gare de l'Est. Eurostar says the whole trip is about 6 hours on one booking. Gare du Nord to Gare de l'Est is a 10 minute walk or about 15 minutes by transport. The fastest TGV Paris to Strasbourg is 1h46 direct; fares start around EUR 25 on SNCF Connect (indicative). [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Hiring a bike

Velhop rental without subscription is EUR 1.20 per hour, EUR 7 for up to 24 hours, EUR 14 for up to 48 hours. Late return costs EUR 14 for each extra 24 hours. The City says Strasbourg has more than 600 km of cycle routes. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Are the cycle lanes safe for kids?

The City says it has the first cycling network in France, with more than 600 km of routes and 6,000 shared Velhop bikes. Whether each lane is suitable for children is not yet confirmed; in December the pedestrian Grande Ile is crowded, so push the bike.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Water & snacks

CHRISTMAS *What is the cup deposit on mulled wine?*

Every drink comes in a returnable cup. The deposit is EUR 1. Hand the cup back at any drinks stall for your EUR 1, or drop it at a charity collection point and the EUR 1 goes to a Strasbourg charity. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *How much is a vin chaud?*

A local guide blog (not official) found 3 to 7 EUR for a standard glass, most at EUR 5, plus the EUR 1 deposit, in 2025. A BFM report in 2023 put the 30 cl glass at EUR 5 including the deposit. 2026 prices not yet confirmed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Can I drink the tap water?

Yes. The Metropole says its tap water meets bacterial and chemical limits and is naturally potable, with only a light preventive chlorination. Bring a refillable bottle. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Toilets

CHRISTMAS *Where are the toilets near the market?*

There are many free public toilets on the Grande Ile, some accessible for disabled visitors. Use the free 'Ici Toilettes' app or the official event map to find permanent and temporary ones and partner businesses. The cathedral platform has none; use the public toilets on Place du Chateau.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Parks & play

CHRISTMAS *Where can the children go?*

Square Louise Weiss (Petite France) hosts the Advent Village: daily storytelling, creative workshops, concerts and games, free. A heated baby and breastfeeding area

CHRISTMAS *Pushchairs, wheelchairs and reduced mobility*

Wheelchairs and walkers can be borrowed free at the information kiosk on Place Kleber (no booking, ID needed). The cathedral

is free in the heart of the festivities; the location is marked on the official map. 2026 programme not yet published.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

platform has no access for people with reduced mobility. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Money & tipping

Do I have to tip?

No. Menu prices must be the price you actually pay, service included ('service compris'). Tipping is optional. Leave coins for good service if you wish.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

Is there a hotel tax on top?

Yes. A tourist tax is charged per person per night and shown separately on the invoice. For unclassified places it is 5% of the pre-tax nightly price plus 10% county add-on, capped at EUR 5.06 per person per night. Under 18s are exempt. Classified hotels have fixed rates (not confirmed on the city page). [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Do the market stalls take cards?*

No official statement found on cash or card at the stalls. Carry some cash and a card. The EUR 1 cup deposit is refundable at any drinks stall. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Phones & data

Will my UK phone cost extra?

Roaming can bring extra charges. Ofcom says to check your package or ask your provider before you go, and check for offers. We did not check each UK network's current France rates. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Emergency numbers

112 for all emergency services. 17 police, 15 ambulance, 18 fire. 114 for deaf and hard of hearing by SMS. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Night chemist

Call 3237 (24 hours) to find the duty pharmacy (pharmacie de garde). The Bas-Rhin pharmacists' union says the call costs EUR 0.35 per minute and is for urgent needs. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Safety habits

CHRISTMAS *What are the security checks at the market?*

Visitors are filtered at the bridges onto the Grande Ile by private security with gendarmes in support. In 2025 large objects were searched automatically and random checks were possible. No ban on bags is stated, but leave big bags and luggage at the hotel. The 2026 plan is not published yet. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Can I drive into the centre?*

No. Motor vehicles are prohibited on the Grande Ile during market hours, unless you hold a pass issued by the City. Walk, cycle, use public transport or the boat.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Pickpockets in the crowds

The UK Foreign Office warns pickpockets work in gangs, one distracts you while another takes from your bag. Keep passport, cards and valuables in separate bags or pockets, carry the bag across your body, keep items close in cafes, and do not get distracted around tourist sights and cash machines. SSMSI recorded 25.8 thefts without violence per 1,000 residents in Strasbourg in 2025, up 16% on 2024.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Terrorism risk at the markets*

FCDO says terrorists are very likely to try to attack in France, including crowded places and cultural events. Stay aware, follow local authority advice and any police instruction. A gunman killed five people at the Strasbourg market on 11 December 2018; a memorial stele is at Place de la Republique.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Knives, pepper spray and self-defence items

Carrying a category D weapon, including a knife or spray, outside your home without a legitimate reason is banned. Self-defence is

Is it safe to drive after a vin chaud?

France has strict drink-driving laws; the legal limit is a third lower than in England and Wales. Police run roadside checks for alcohol and drugs. Penalties include fines,

not accepted as a legitimate reason. Penalty up to EUR 15,000 and 1 year in prison (EUR 30,000 and 2 years if with another person). Leave them at home.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

loss of licence and prison. Drinks in French bars are often stronger than in the UK.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

New Year's Eve in Strasbourg

On 31 Dec 2025 most petards and fireworks were banned in Bas-Rhin to 3 Jan 2026, under-16s not accompanied had a curfew in Strasbourg and six nearby towns, and 117 to 123 cars were burnt in the area depending on the count. Trouble was mostly between 23:00 and 02:00 in suburbs; Place Kleber was cleared at about 00:20. Avoid parking in suburbs, avoid fireworks crowds. 2026/27 rules NOT yet announced. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Must I carry ID?

Yes. You must be able to prove who you are when asked, or within 4 hours at a police station. A passport, photocard driving licence or other government document is accepted. Covering your face in public is illegal, with a fine up to EUR 150.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

Local ways

Passport and entry rules for UK visitors

On a British passport you can visit the Schengen area for up to 90 days in any 180. Passport issue date must be under 10 years before arrival and expiry at least 3 months after you leave. The EU Entry/Exit System registers fingerprints and a photo on first entry (free); children 11 and under give a photo only. If you leave from St Pancras, checks happen before you leave the UK. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Do I need ETIAS?

GOV.UK says the EU is expected to start ETIAS from autumn 2026 and that no action is needed from travellers at this point. The EU says it will announce the start date several months ahead. Exact start date not yet confirmed. Check gov.uk and travel-europe.europa.eu before you book.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS ***Are shops open on Sundays in December?***

CHRISTMAS ***Is 26 December a day off?***

Yes in Alsace-Moselle. 26 December (St Stephen's Day) is an extra public holiday

In Alsace-Moselle shops are normally closed on Sundays and public holidays, except types such as bakeries, florists, souvenir shops, takeaway food and shops in stations. In 2025 the Prefect allowed Strasbourg shops to open on the four Advent Sundays and on 28 December (11:00 to 19:00). The 2026 order is not yet confirmed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

there. In 2026 it falls on a Saturday. Expect most shops shut that day. Market opening on 25 and 26 Dec not yet confirmed for Strasbourg. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *How do I avoid the crowds?*

The City says Mondays, Tuesdays and mornings are quietest. Wednesday afternoons, Friday evenings and the whole weekend are very crowded. In 2024 the market had more than 3.4 million visitors. In 2025 some streets were one-way at weekends and the Place Kleber social zone was closed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Do the opening hours change on Christmas Eve?*

The City says stalls open 11:30 to 21:00 daily, but close at 18:00 on 24 December so vendors can celebrate. City museums close early (16:00) on 24 Dec and are shut on 25 and 31 Dec and 1 Jan. The City lists the cathedral as closed on 25 Dec 2026, but the cathedral's own feast-day hours are 14:00 to 17:15, so check before going. Opening on 25 Dec for stalls not yet confirmed. [Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Are dogs allowed at the market?*

Yes, on a leash. The City suggests mornings or early in the week because of the crowds.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Cathedral clock show at Christmas*

The astronomical clock show at 12:30 will not take place during the Christmas market, according to the cathedral parish site. Do not plan around it. The cathedral itself opens Mon to Sat; the platform climb (330 steps, EUR 10 adult) closes 25 Dec.

[Checked 2026-10 ↗](#)

Official travel advice for 200+ countries, community reports, one-tap SOS, and QR wristbands so lost children and lost bags find their way back.

Our sources

This guide summarises these creators' videos in our own words. Watch the originals - they are worth it. Crime data: SSMSI, Ministère de l'Intérieur - recorded crime by commune, 2025 (Jan 2025 to Dec 2025). Commune and department crime databases (2025 edition, published 9 July 2026 on data.gouv.fr), Eurostat crim_gen_reg for Bas-Rhin (2024), the Préfecture du Bas-Rhin and City of Strasbourg market security plan (November 2025), regional press on New Year's Eve 2025/26, and FCDO France advice (11 August 2026). Rates are per resident, not adjusted for visitors; no street-level data is published.

1. [STRASBOURG CITY TOUR / FRANCE 4K](#)
AbouTravel · 2026-08
2. [The Best and Worst Foods at the Strasbourg Christmas Market](#)
Alex and Mehmet · 2024-12
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